

SRI LANKA

Key Country Details: Sri Lanka

Detail	Information
Full Name	Democratic Socialist Republic of Sri Lanka
Short Form	Sri Lanka
Capital	Legislative: Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte; Executive & Judicial: Colombo
Region (UN)	Asia – South Asia
Government Type	Unitary semi-presidential constitutional republic
Head of State	President Anura Kumara Disanayake
Head of Government	President Anura Kumara Disanayake
Currency	Sri Lankan Rupee (LKR)
UN Member Since	1955
MUN Standing	Active in peacekeeping, climate negotiations, and human rights debates.

Recommended Books

1. *Foreign Policy of Sri Lanka: A Third World Perspective* – Shelton Kodikara
https://books.google.com/books/about/Foreign_Policy_of_Sri_Lanka.html?id=CV1uAAAAMAAJ
2. *Sri Lanka's Foreign Policy: A Study in Non-Alignment* – H.S.S. Nissanka
<https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/4659169-sri-lanka-s-foreign-policy>
3. *Shaping the Future of Sri Lanka's Foreign Policy* – Lakshman Kadirgamar Institute
<https://lki.lk/book/shaping-the-future-of-sri-lankas-foreign-policy/>
4. *Documents on Sri Lanka's Foreign Policy, 1947–1965* – K.M. de Silva
<https://www.amazon.com/Documents-Lankas-Foreign-Policy-1947-1965/dp/9558051322>
5. *Essays on Sri Lanka's Foreign Policy: Volume I* – W.M. Karunadasa
https://www.goodreads.com/author/list/7036050.W_M_Karunadasa

Sri Lanka & UNHRC Research Table

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Sri Lanka	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/sri-lanka	Country profile, treaty adherence, and official reviews.
Universal Periodic Review – Sri Lanka	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/lk-index	Periodic peer reviews and response reports.
Amnesty International – Sri Lanka	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/asia-and-the-pacific/south-asia/sri-lanka/	Reports on human rights violations and recommendations.
Human Rights Watch – Sri Lanka	https://www.hrw.org/asia/sri-lanka	Documentation of ongoing human rights concerns.
Freedom House – Sri Lanka Score	https://freedomhouse.org/country/sri-lanka/freedom-world/2024	Analysis of political freedoms and civil liberties.
Sri Lanka Bar Association – HR Reports	https://basl.lk	Legal updates on human rights cases.
Crisis Group – Sri Lanka Human Rights	https://www.crisisgroup.org/asia/south-asia/sri-lanka	Conflict and post-war accountability analyses.

Source Name	Link
OHCHR – Sri Lanka UPR Hub	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/lk-index (icj.org, ohchr.org)
HRW – UPR Submission (Jul 2022)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2022/07/15/submission-universal-periodic-review-sri-lanka
HRW – UPR Submission (2008 PDF)	https://upr-info.org/sites/default/files/documents/2013-10/hrwkauprs22008humanrightswatchuprsubmission.pdf
OHCHR – UPR Submission (2022 PDF)	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=10690
OHCHR – Joint NGO Submission (2022 PDF)	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=10718
OHCHR – Third Cycle Contributions	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/upr-sri-lanka-un-contributions-s28
CIVICUS – UPR Submission (2023)	https://www.civicus.org/documents/CCPR137_SriLanka_CIVICUS.pdf
HRW – LLRC Letter (2010 PDF)	https://www.hrw.org/sites/default/files/related_material/LLRC%20joint%20letter%20FINAL%2013%20Oct%202010.pdf
ICJ – UPR Submission (2017 PDF)	https://www.icj.org/wp-content/uploads/2017/04/SriLanka-UPR-Submission-March17-Advocacy-non-legal-submissions-2017-ENG.pdf

OHCHR – UPR Stakeholder List	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/upr-sri-lanka-stakeholders-info-s28
OHCHR – UPR Mid-cycle Archives	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/lk-web-archives
OHCHR – LLRC Transitional Justice Report	https://www.ohchr.org/en/documents/country-reports/promoting-reconciliation-accountability-and-human-rights-sri-lanka-report
HRW – Protest Crackdowns (2021)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2021/02/09/thousands-march-justice-sri-lanka-despite-ban
HRW – COVID Cremation Order (2021)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2021/01/18/sri-lanka-covid-19-forced-cremation-muslims-discriminatory
HRW – Police Abuse Amid COVID (2021)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2021/08/06/sri-lanka-police-abuses-surge-amid-covid-19-pandemic
HRW – Muslim Persecution (2019)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2019/07/03/sri-lanka-muslims-face-threats-attacks
HRW – Dissent Suppression (2020)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2020/08/08/sri-lanka-increasing-suppression-dissent
CPJ – Journalists Murdered (Reporter Data)	https://cpj.org/data/killed/asia/sri-lanka/

10 Unique Aspects: Sri Lanka at UNHRC

1. **Recurring UPR Momentum—Yet Limited Implementation:** Sri Lanka engages earnestly with UPR cycles, but mid- and post-review follow-up consistently remains shallow.
2. **Post-War Impunity Systemic Issue:** Both HRW and ICJ submissions detail persistent impunity for war-era atrocities and enforced disappearances.
3. **Transitional Justice UN Mandate Stalled:** Despite resolution 30/1 objectives, the OHCHR war-era accountability report identified minimal progress.
4. **Religious Discrimination via COVID Edicts:** Forced cremations of Muslim victims sparked UN outrage on religious rights violations.

5. **Violent Suppression of Protests:** UN-documented examples of police brutality during anti-government demonstrations underscore civil assembly issues.
 6. **Broad Anti-Terror Law Enforcement**
 7. **Civic Space Under Threat:** Arrests of activists and human rights defenders have been repeatedly flagged by HRW, impacting UNHRC dialogue.
 8. **Media Endangerment and Fabricated Charges:** The murder data from CPJ reflects heightened risks against journalists—a central Council issue.
 9. **Ethno-Religious Tensions on UN Radar:** Discrimination and attacks on Muslims are consistently monitored by HRW and shared in UN sessions.
 10. **COVID-Enabled Rights Rollbacks:** Emergency orders during the pandemic were used to suppress expression and minorities, raising concerns among UN experts.
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